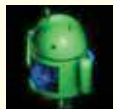


ADVANCE ANDROID CUSTOMIZATION

The one thing that really pulls users to the Android OS is its openness and high customisability. Dive into more advanced tweaks and customizations with the Xposed framework and more on your android device.

<http://dgit.in/ArootAD>

SLOT MACHINE HACK

A casino earns about 7.129 cents for every dollar played. Digging through source code, Russian hackers engineered a brilliant slot machine cheat. The casinos eventually spotted the culprit using surveillance tapes, but they still have no idea how to fix it.

<http://dgit.in/slothack>

SMARTER BOTS = SMARTER YOU

In the coming years, artificial intelligence will replace a lot of human jobs. As AI continues to improve they could eventually help us improve at our jobs as well. The descendants of Siri and Alexa could change our daily lives and even thoughts one day.

<http://dgit.in/JobAI>

ARE VPNS REALLY SAFE?

Most Mobile VPNs may not be as safe as you think. Virtual private networks, which shield your web traffic from prying eyes, have rightly garnered more attention. But before you use a VPN to hide your online browsing history, here's what you need to know.

<http://dgit.in/VPNUnsafe>

Wear me not: is the era of fitness trackers and smartwatches nearing its end?



The numbers aren't looking good, neither is the state of some of the key players in the wearables industry.

– By Adamya Sharma

Fitbit laid off 6% of its workforce. Pebble shut shop. Jawbone is reportedly planning to exit the wearable space and enter the medical tech arena. Misfit handed over its business to Fossil way back in 2015. The wearable world is stagnant and in a downward spiral. Will it stand the test of time? Are you still using that smartwatch you picked up 6 months ago? Are fitness trackers purely riding on a novelty factor? Do we really need another device to charge? Let's try to answer these, and other pertinent questions.

Why are we buying wearables in India?

To say that wearables do not attract the same enthusiasm as smartphones would be an understatement, at least in the 'developing market' we live in. However, market reports will tell you that Indians are still stocking up on wearables. According to a report by the International Data Corporation, wearables clocked just over 400,000 units in the first quarter of 2016. They continued their successful streak through to the second quarter of 2016, with a jump of 41.9 percent over the previous quarter.



Chinese manufacturer Xiaomi led the rally of wearable shipments in India for the first quarter. Native GOQii took the title away in the second quarter. Fitbit sat comfortably in the third spot through both quarters.

While a robust growth trajectory looks good on paper for the wearables industry in India, it may not remain in the green for long. The same IDC report goes to show that Indians are more likely to buy basic activity trackers, instead of smart wearables that run third-party apps such as the Apple Watch or the Samsung Gear S3. Here in India, it all comes down to price and novelty. While the latter may also be a factor that influences wearables' purchases in countries like the US and UK, price sensitivity is,



and has been, a crucial deciding factor for Indians. A ₹1,999 Mi Band 2 is any day more attractive to the Indian buyer than a ₹14,999 FitBit Charge 2 or a ₹32,900 Apple Watch 2. In fact, almost 94% of wearables accounted for in IDC's Q2 2016 numbers account for 'basic bands and trackers'. "The average price of over \$190 has had a negative impact on smart wearables (smartwatches and such) as it is still perceived as a premium device which not many consumers can afford," Raj Nimesh, Senior Market Analyst - Client Devices, IDC, writes in the report.

A new toy to play with, or as we called it earlier, novelty, is the second factor that influences wearables' purchases in India. That, coupled with an affordable price tag, is a recipe for success that many